Code on paper

Programming · Level 4 · Lesson 3



Today we will

- Use Parsons strips, trace tables and desk checks.
- Assess programming fairly on paper.
- Use Darsi’s printed worksheets.

Remember

- Trace tables show how a program really runs.
- Paper homework is fair to every pupil.
- Paper first; one phone is the judge.

Paper first

1. Warm-up (5 min): Predict a loop’s output on paper.
2. Trace (10 min): Fill in a trace table, row by row.
3. Strips (10 min): Order and indent Parsons strips.
4. Desk check (10 min): Swap and check another pair’s work.
5. Wrap-up (5 min): One phone runs the programs. Exit ticket.

This lesson works with no power and no devices; the phone at the end is optional.

Let’s discuss

1. What did the trace tables show that running the code wouldn’t?
2. How could you assess your next unit on paper?
3. Which pupils benefit most from paper-first lessons?

Exit ticket

- Write one paper question that tests loops, and its answer.